



Innovative English Olympiad

Model Paper 2025 – 2026

Total Questions: 50

Time: 1.5 hr.

Total Marks: 100

Syllabus

Vocabulary and Functional Grammar: Parts of speech and their correct usage in the sentences, articles, tenses, punctuations, jumbled words, syllables, and word formation; vocabulary development; analogies; synonyms and antonyms; determiners, quantifiers, collocations; phrasal verbs; clauses and phrases; sentence structure; subject-verb agreement; identifying the odd-one-out; one-word substitutes; idiomatic expressions; direct and indirect speech; active and passive voice; etc.

Reading Comprehension: Understanding the story holistically and interpreting information in detail; comprehending phrases, phrasal verbs, and idioms both contextually and independently; analysing specific details and their implications; extracting information about events, characters, and references within the text; identifying underlying messages and moral perspectives; and related comprehension skills.

Interactive English: Using language for exchanging pleasantries; greeting; thanking; apologising; offering consolation; giving warnings; expressing opinions and advice; showing polite disagreement; introducing oneself; making requests; seeking permission; conveying information clearly and completely; and demonstrating proper etiquette in personal as well as telephonic conversations.

Instructions:

1. This question paper contains 50 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The duration of the examination is 90 minutes.
3. Each question carries 2 marks. There is no negative marks for wrong answers.
4. Use only blue or black ball-point pen to mark your answers on the OMR Answer Sheet.
5. The use of calculators, mobile phones, smart watches, log tables, or any electronic gadgets is strictly prohibited.

English

1. Choose the option where the underlined word is used as a **different part of speech** from the others:
(A) Light travels faster than sound.
(B) Please light the candle.
(C) The room was filled with light.
(D) She carried a light bag.
2. Choose the correct analogy:
Resilient : Strength :: Fragile : ?
(A) Power (B) Weakness
(C) Break (D) Pressure
3. Choose the correct synonym of **IMPLICIT**
(A) Obvious (B) Clear
(C) Indirect (D) Explicit

4. Choose the correct antonym of **TRANSIENT**
 (A) Temporary (B) Brief
 (C) Permanent (D) Passing
5. Choose the correct one-word substitute:
 A person who deliberately sets fire to property
 (A) Pyromaniac (B) Arsonist
 (C) Firefighter (D) Incendiary
6. Choose the sentence with correct article usage:
 (A) She is a MBA graduate.
 (B) She is an MBA graduate.
 (C) She is the MBA graduate.
 (D) She is MBA graduate.
7. Identify the sentence with correct **degree of comparison**:
 (A) This is the most easiest method.
 (B) This method is easier than all others.
 (C) This method is the easiest of all.
 (D) This is more easier method.
8. Choose the sentence containing a **transitive verb**:
 (A) The baby slept peacefully.
 (B) The glass broke suddenly.
 (C) She completed the assignment.
 (D) The sun rose early.
9. Choose the correct sequence of tenses:
 He said that he _____ the report after the meeting ended.
 (A) finishes (B) has finished
 (C) would finish (D) will finish
10. Identify the sentence expressing an **opinion**:
 (A) Water boils at 100°C.
 (B) The novel was published in 2015.
 (C) This movie is the best I've ever seen.
 (D) The train arrived late.
11. Identify the **complex sentence**:
 (A) She worked hard and succeeded.
 (B) She worked hard because she wanted to succeed.
 (C) She worked hard; she succeeded.
 (D) She worked hard to succeed.
12. Change into passive voice:
 The committee will announce the results tomorrow.
 (A) The results were announced tomorrow.
 (B) The results will be announced by the committee tomorrow.
 (C) The results are announced tomorrow.
 (D) The committee will be announced tomorrow.
13. Change into indirect speech:
 He said, "I have never seen such chaos."
 (A) He said that he has never seen such chaos.
 (B) He said that he never saw such chaos.
 (C) He said that he had never seen such chaos.
 (D) He said that he will never see such chaos.

- 14.** Choose the correct conditional sentence:
- (A) If he will study, he will pass.
 (B) If he studied, he will pass.
 (C) If he studies, he will pass.
 (D) If he study, he will pass.
- 15.** Choose the correct meaning of the idiom “burn the midnight oil”:
- (A) Waste energy
 (B) Work late into the night
 (C) Sleep late
 (D) Destroy resources
- 16.** Identify the sentence with **correct punctuation**:
- (A) However the plan failed unexpectedly.
 (B) However, the plan failed unexpectedly.
 (C) However; the plan, failed unexpectedly.
 (D) However the plan, failed unexpectedly.
- 17.** Identify the part of the sentence that has an error:
 Neither of the answers are correct.
- (A) Neither (B) of the
 (C) answers are (D) correct
- 18.** Choose the correct question form:
 You completed the assignment on time, _____?
- (A) did you (B) didn't you
 (C) haven't you (D) won't you
- 19.** Choose the odd one out:
- (A) Allegation (B) Accusation
 (C) Complaint (D) Apology

- 20.** Choose the correct homonym based on context:
 He could not _____ the effect of the medicine.
- (A) bare (B) bear
 (C) beer (D) bore

Cloze Passage: Read the passage and answer Q 21–23

Success rarely comes overnight. It is built through consistent effort, careful planning, and the ability to learn from failure. Those who give up easily often miss opportunities that perseverance might have revealed.

- 21.** Choose the correct word to complete the sentence:
 Success rarely comes _____.
- (A) quickly (B) overnight
 (C) suddenly (D) instantly
- 22.** Which word best replaces “revealed” in the passage?
- (A) hidden (B) ignored
 (C) shown (D) destroyed
- 23.** The central idea of the passage is that success requires
- (A) luck (B) intelligence
 (C) perseverance (D) competition
- 24.** One-word substitute for “a life history written by oneself”:
- (A) Biography (B) Autobiography
 (C) Memoir (D) Diary
- 25.** Choose the sentence that is grammatically correct:
- (A) She suggested me to take rest.
 (B) She suggested that I take rest.
 (C) She suggested me taking rest.
 (D) She suggested I to take rest.

(Situational judgement & formal communication)

- 26.** Choose the most polite way to seek permission:
- (A) Let me go.
 - (B) Can I leave now, please?
 - (C) I am leaving.
 - (D) I want to go.
- 27.** Choose the appropriate response to a complaint:
- (A) That's not my problem.
 - (B) I'll look into the matter immediately.
 - (C) Why are you complaining?
 - (D) You are wrong.
- 28.** Choose the correct formal telephone expression:
- (A) Who are you?
 - (B) May I speak to the manager, please?
 - (C) Give me the manager.
 - (D) Put the manager on.
- 29.** Choose the correct sentence for **giving advice**:
- (A) You must do it now.
 - (B) Why didn't you do it earlier?
 - (C) You might consider revising the chapter again.
 - (D) Do it immediately.
- 30.** Choose the polite way to **disagree**:
- (A) You are completely wrong.
 - (B) That makes no sense.
 - (C) I understand your view, but I see it differently.
 - (D) You don't know anything.

Formal Writing Awareness

- 31.** Which sentence is suitable for a **job application**?
- (A) I need this job badly.
 - (B) Please give me this job.
 - (C) I wish to apply for the post advertised.
 - (D) I am jobless now.
- 32.** Which detail is **essential** in a CV?
- (A) Favourite colour
 - (B) Height
 - (C) Educational qualifications
 - (D) Daily routine
- 33.** Choose the best way to **inform** someone formally:
- (A) Guess what happened!
 - (B) Just telling you this.
 - (C) This is to inform you that the meeting is postponed.
 - (D) The meeting is off, okay?
- 34.** Choose the correct response to console someone:
- (A) Stop crying.
 - (B) It's your fault.
 - (C) I understand how you feel; things will improve.
 - (D) Don't overreact.
- 35.** Choose the sentence that best **warns** politely:
- (A) Don't do this again.
 - (B) You will regret this.
 - (C) Please be careful; this area is restricted.
 - (D) This is dangerous, stay away.

Passage 1: Learning Beyond Failure

Tuesday evening

Today did not go as planned. I had prepared thoroughly for the debate, yet when I stood on the stage, my thoughts scattered. Words that felt confident in rehearsal refused to surface. Walking back to my seat, I felt disappointment weigh heavily on me.

However, as the day progressed, something unexpected happened. A classmate quietly told me that my ideas were strong, even if my delivery faltered. That comment forced me to reflect. I realised that failure does not erase effort; it merely exposes areas that demand refinement.

Tonight, instead of replaying my embarrassment, I have chosen to analyse it. Tomorrow, I will practise speaking aloud, control my pace, and learn to pause instead of panic. Perhaps success is not about never failing, but about responding wisely when failure arrives.

36. Why was the writer disappointed initially?
- (A) The audience interrupted
 - (B) The debate topic was unfamiliar
 - (C) The writer forgot what to say
 - (D) The classmates criticised the performance
37. What caused the writer's change in perspective?
- (A) Teacher's advice
 - (B) Winning appreciation
 - (C) A classmate's comment
 - (D) Personal reflection at home
38. The phrase "failure does not erase effort" suggests that

- (A) effort always leads to success
- (B) effort has no value
- (C) failure hides mistakes
- (D) effort remains meaningful despite failure

39. The writer plans to improve by

- (A) avoiding debates
- (B) memorising speeches
- (C) practising controlled speaking
- (D) changing topics

40. The tone of the passage is best described as

- (A) Bitter and angry
- (B) Reflective and hopeful
- (C) Critical and sarcastic
- (D) Casual and humorous

Passage 2: The Price of Convenience

In recent years, food delivery services have transformed urban lifestyles. With a few taps on a screen, meals arrive at doorsteps, saving time and effort. While this convenience has been widely welcomed, its long-term consequences deserve closer examination.

The surge in delivery culture has led to excessive packaging waste. Plastic containers, cutlery, and bags are often discarded within minutes of use, contributing significantly to environmental pollution. Moreover, frequent dependence on delivered food reduces awareness of nutrition, as consumers become detached from food preparation and ingredients. Convenience, therefore, comes at a cost. Unless both companies and consumers adopt responsible practices—such as eco-friendly packaging and mindful

consumption—the comfort of today may create irreversible problems for tomorrow.

- 41.** The passage mainly discusses
- (A) growth of restaurants
 - (B) benefits of cooking at home
 - (C) impact of food delivery services
 - (D) urban transportation
- 42.** What environmental issue is highlighted?
- (A) Air pollution
 - (B) Noise pollution
 - (C) Packaging waste
 - (D) Water scarcity
- 43.** According to the passage, frequent food delivery may reduce
- (A) appetite
 - (B) social interaction
 - (C) nutritional awareness
 - (D) financial savings
- 44.** The author's attitude towards convenience can be described as
- (A) fully supportive
 - (B) completely negative
 - (C) balanced and cautionary
 - (D) indifferent
- 45.** The passage suggests that responsibility should be taken by
- (A) only delivery companies
 - (B) only consumers
 - (C) governments alone
 - (D) both companies and consumers

Passage 3: The Choice That Defined Him
Rahul found a wallet lying near the school gate. Inside it were several notes and an identity card belonging to a stranger. For a moment, Rahul hesitated. The money could solve his immediate problems, and no one seemed to be watching.

Yet, as he turned the wallet over in his hands, he imagined the worry of the person who had lost it. Acting on impulse, he went to the school office and handed it over. Later that day, the owner arrived, relieved and grateful beyond words.

Rahul did not receive any reward, but as he walked home, he felt lighter. He understood that integrity does not always bring applause, but it builds a quiet confidence that no shortcut ever could.

- 46.** What dilemma did Rahul face?
- (A) Whether to keep the wallet or return it
 - (B) Whether to go home early
 - (C) Whether to report to school
 - (D) Whether to ask for help
- 47.** What motivated Rahul to return the wallet?
- (A) Fear of punishment
 - (B) Expectation of reward
 - (C) Empathy for the owner
 - (D) Advice from friends
- 48.** The phrase “quiet confidence” refers to
- (A) pride shown openly
 - (B) happiness from honesty
 - (C) fear of being caught
 - (D) approval from others

49.What is the central theme of the passage?

- (A) Luck determines success
- (B) Money brings happiness
- (C) Integrity shapes character
- (D) Courage leads to rewards

50.The ending of the passage can best be described as

- (A) tragic
- (B) humorous
- (C) morally satisfying
- (D) unexpected

KEY

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|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1) B | 2) B | 3) C | 4) C | 5) B | 6) B | 7) C |
| 8) C | 9) C | 10) C | 11) B | 12) B | 13) C | 14) C |
| 15) B | 16) B | 17) C | 18) B | 19) D | 20) B | 21) B |
| 22) C | 23) C | 24) B | 25) B | 26) B | 27) B | 28) B |
| 29) C | 30) C | 31) C | 32) C | 33) C | 34) C | 35) C |
| 36) C | 37) C | 38) D | 39) C | 40) B | 41) C | 42) C |
| 43) C | 44) C | 45) D | 46) A | 47) C | 48) B | 49) C |
| 50) C | | | | | | |